

Backend Configuration & Data Setup – Business Schedule Configuration

Business Schedule Configuration

Overview

A **Business Schedule** defines the organization's official working days and business hours that ServiceNow uses to calculate Service Level Agreements (SLAs). Instead of calculating SLA time continuously over 24 hours, the schedule ensures that SLA timers run only during designated business hours.

For this project, a business schedule named **IT Support Business Hours** is created to reflect the working hours of the IT Support team. This schedule is then associated with the Incident Resolution SLA, ensuring accurate SLA tracking and preventing SLA calculations during weekends or non-working hours.

Objective

The objectives of configuring the Business Schedule are to:

- Define official IT support working hours.
 - Ensure SLA timers calculate only during business hours.
 - Exclude weekends from SLA calculations.
 - Improve the accuracy of SLA monitoring.
 - Support proactive SLA governance and compliance.
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Navigation

Navigate to the Business Schedule configuration page using the following path:

System Scheduler → Schedules

Click **New** to create a new schedule.

Screenshot of the ServiceNow interface showing the 'Update Sets' page. The left sidebar is open, displaying a search bar with 'scheduled' and a list of results under 'ALL RESULTS'. The main table shows columns: Name, State, Installed from, Created, Created by, Parent, and Batch Size. Two rows are visible, both in 'In progress' state.

Name	State	Installed from	Created	Created by	Parent	Batch Size
	In progress		2025-07-08 02:03:42	admin	(empty)	(empty)
	In progress		2025-04-30 08:40:08	system	(empty)	(empty)

Screenshot of the ServiceNow interface showing the 'Schedule - New Record' form. The form fields are filled with the following values:

- Name: IT Support Business Hours
- Time zone: US/Hawaii
- Parent: (empty)
- Application: Global
- Type: (empty)
- Description: (empty)

The 'Submit' button is visible at the bottom left of the form area.

Name	Type	Time zone	Updated
B-5 weekdays			2008-07-09 11:17:57
B-5 weekdays including holidays			2008-07-09 11:21:57
Application	application		2008-11-04 13:37:05
Application FLX	maintenance	GMT	2011-01-14 02:56:35
Blackout Weekends (GMT)	blackout	GMT	2011-07-20 09:48:55
Database Server FLX	maintenance	GMT	2011-01-14 03:34:45
Global Infrastructure	maintenance		2011-06-03 04:16:37
IT Support Business Hours		US-East	2016-07-08 02:23:13
MySQL Database Service	maintenance		2011-06-03 03:46:30
Network	network		2009-01-14 18:13:51
Network CAD		US-Pacific	2016-07-13 02:04:38
Non-US Holidays			2017-01-14 14:46:53
Server	server		2008-11-04 21:05:04
Servers San Diego	maintenance	US-Pacific	2011-06-03 04:04:17
Software Blackout	blackout		2011-06-03 04:44:58
U.S. Holidays			2012-03-15 21:24:28
WebServer FLX	maintenance	GMT	2011-01-14 03:34:53
Weekends	maintenance	US-Pacific	2009-09-10 15:58:26

Step 1: Create a New Business Schedule

After clicking **New**, enter the schedule details.

Schedule Details

Field **Value**

Name IT Support Business Hours

Time Zone IST (Asia/Kolkata) or your organization's local time zone

After entering the details:

1. Click **Submit** or **Save**.
2. Open the newly created schedule.

Step 2: Create Schedule Entries

After saving the schedule:

1. Scroll to the **Schedule Entries** related list.
2. Click **New**.

Enter the following information:

Field	Value
Days	Monday – Friday
Start Time	09:00 AM
End Time	06:00 PM
Show As	Busy

Click **Submit** to save the schedule entry.

The completed schedule now represents the standard working hours of the IT Support team.

Configuration Summary

Configuration	Value
Schedule Name	IT Support Business Hours
Working Days	Monday – Friday
Business Hours	09:00 AM – 06:00 PM
Time Zone	IST (Asia/Kolkata)
Availability	Busy

Purpose of the Business Schedule

The Business Schedule is used by the ServiceNow SLA engine to:

- Calculate SLA elapsed time.
- Calculate remaining SLA time.
- Pause SLA timers outside business hours.
- Exclude weekends from calculations.
- Improve SLA accuracy based on organizational working hours.

Benefits

Implementing a Business Schedule provides several advantages:

- Accurate SLA calculations using business hours.
 - Prevents SLA timers from running on weekends.
 - Reflects real IT support availability.
 - Improves SLA compliance monitoring.
 - Ensures fair measurement of incident resolution time.
 - Supports audit-ready SLA reporting.
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Validation

After configuration, verify that:

- The **IT Support Business Hours** schedule is successfully created.
 - The schedule contains one or more entries for **Monday–Friday**.
 - Working hours are configured as **09:00 AM to 06:00 PM**.
 - The **Time Zone** is correctly set to **IST (Asia/Kolkata)** or the organization's local time zone.
 - The schedule is linked to the Incident Resolution SLA.
 - SLA timers stop outside configured business hours and resume during the next business period.
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Expected Outcome

Once the Business Schedule is configured and associated with the Incident Resolution SLA:

- SLA calculations follow official business hours.
 - Weekend and non-working hours are excluded.
 - Incident Resolution SLAs are measured accurately.
 - SLA monitoring becomes more reliable.
 - The foundation is established for proactive notifications, Virtual Agent interactions, reporting, and governance.
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Conclusion

The **Business Schedule Configuration** is an essential component of the backend setup for the **Virtual Agent–Driven SLA Breach Awareness & Justification System**. By defining the IT Support team's working days and hours, ServiceNow accurately measures SLA performance based on actual operational time. This configuration improves SLA compliance, supports governance objectives, and ensures reliable, audit-ready SLA calculations across the Incident Management process.